Well Worth It

A tap-to-build clean-water game concept for college engagement

Sahar Rao • Summer 2026 • Digital wireframe + written experience plan

Concept in one line: players build a clean-water project by completing accessible hold-to-fill challenges, then use their earned droplets to develop a village, read impact stories, and track a personal best.

Concept overview

Well Worth It turns the journey toward clean water into a hopeful, repeatable game loop. A player clears sediment from a mountain spring, connects progress to village buildings, learns through human-centered stories, and returns for small goals and rewards. The experience is designed for college students who want a quick, visually clear way to engage with a real-world issue without requiring a long tutorial.

Audience and experience goals

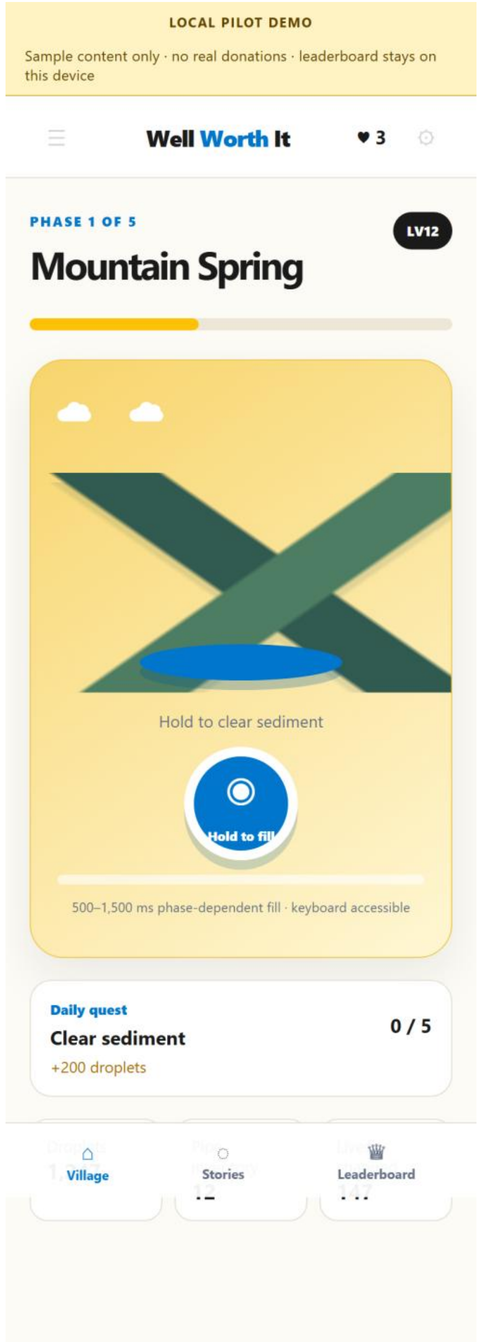
- Primary audience: college students who are comfortable with mobile games and short social experiences.
- Emotional goal: move from curiosity to empathy to action through visible progress and respectful storytelling.
- Usability goal: make the core interaction understandable in seconds and playable with touch or keyboard.
- Awareness goal: connect game progress to the importance of reliable access to clean water without presenting fictional metrics as real impact.

How the game works

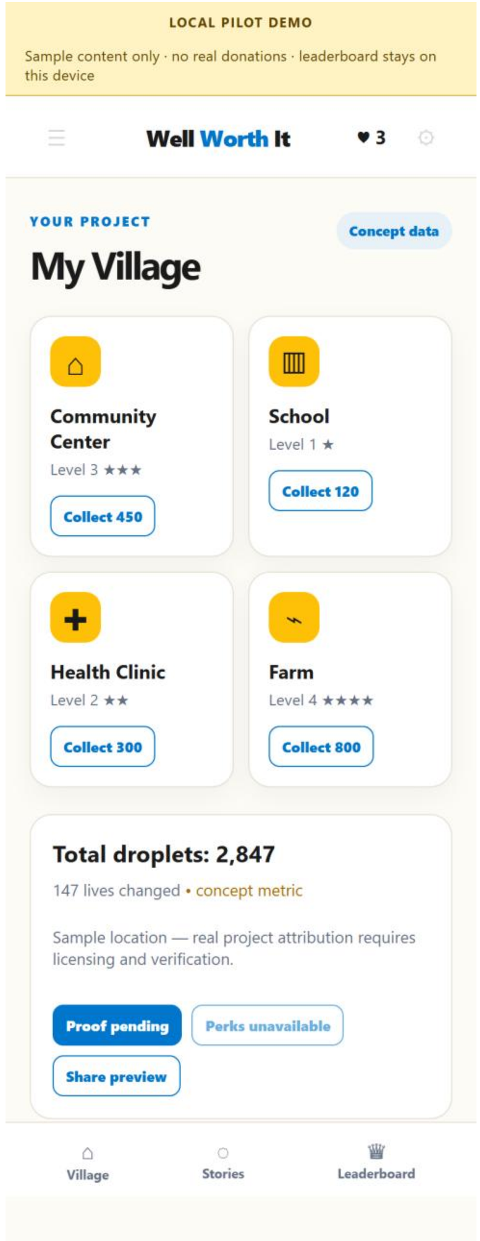
- Start: the player sees the Mountain Spring phase and a clear “Hold to fill” action.
- Play: holding the spring button fills a progress meter; releasing early cancels the attempt. Keyboard Enter/Space provides an alternative input.
- Reward: a completed phase adds 200 droplets and advances the daily quest. Feedback changes the button label to “Spring cleared.”
- Build: droplets support deterministic village building collections in the local prototype.
- Learn: Stories presents sample story cards with a free reading path; donation actions remain disabled until content and payment approvals exist.
- Return: the local leaderboard shows personal-best-style sample rows and clearly states that cross-campus ranking requires a verified backend.

Digital wireframe board

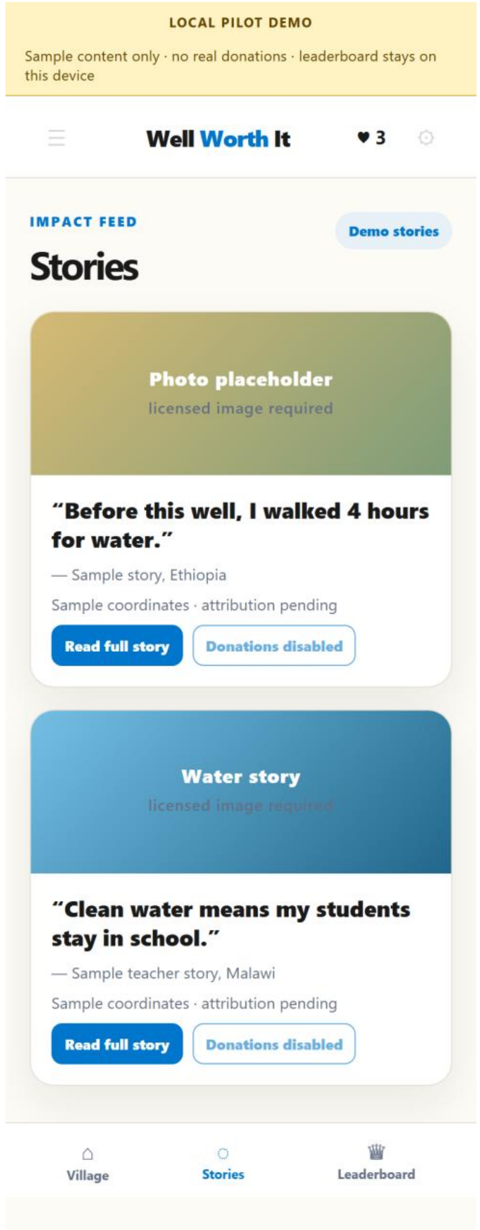
The following screens are rendered from the working prototype at mobile size 390 × 844. Labels, concept pills, and the local-pilot banner make the intended states clear for review.



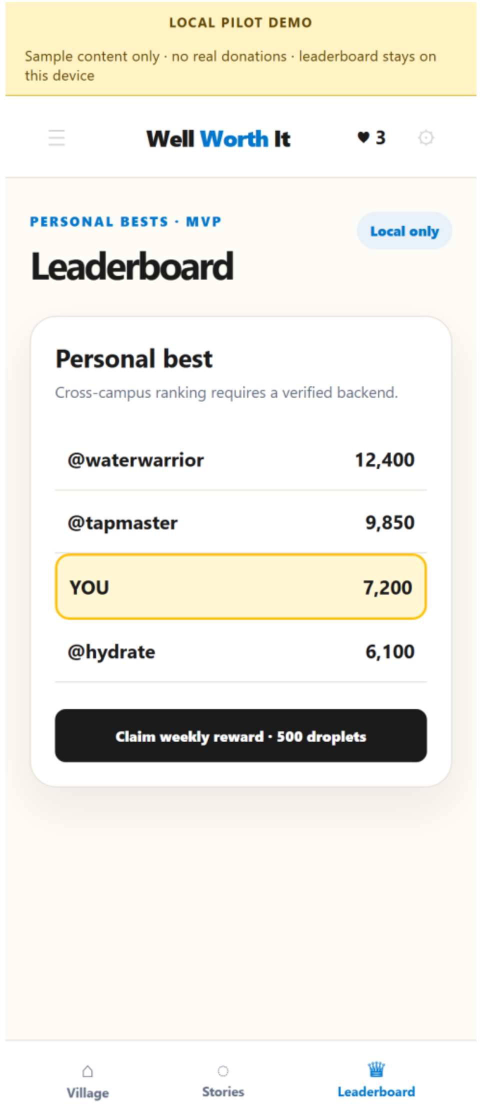
Screen 1 — Main Game: phase status, spring interaction, progress meter, daily quest, and HUD.



Screen 2 — My Village: four building cards, concept impact metric, proof state, and local actions.



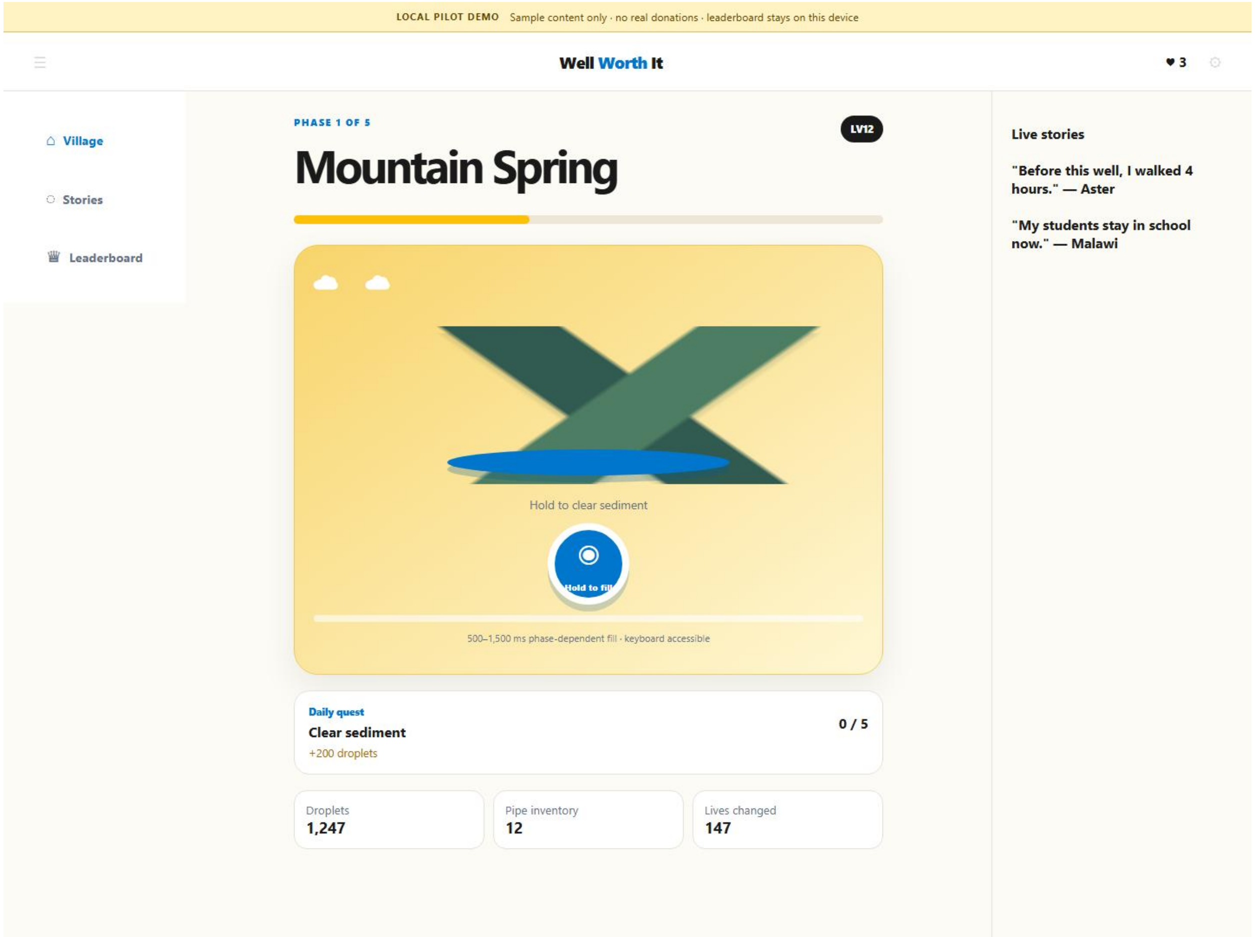
Screen 3 — Stories: sample story cards, source/licensing status, and disabled donation path.



Screen 4 — Leaderboard: personal-best presentation with a clear local-only boundary.

Desktop adaptation

On larger screens, the mobile navigation becomes a persistent left rail, the main game remains in the center, and a live-stories panel appears on the right. The visual hierarchy stays consistent so the player does not learn a separate desktop product.



Desktop/tablet adaptation — persistent navigation, central game loop, and story context panel.

Visual design and branding plan

The concept uses a warm, optimistic visual system inspired by the assignment's charity: water direction while keeping the prototype clearly labeled as independent and unendorsed. Any future use of official logos, photographs, stories, project data, or donation links would require written permission and verified sources.

Token	Use	Why it helps
Warm yellow #FFC107	Actions, rewards, progress highlights	Creates energy and makes rewards easy to find.
Charcoal #1A1A1A	Headings, navigation, high-priority text	Provides strong contrast and a grounded tone.
Water blue #0077CC	Links, water effects, status accents	Connects the interface to the water mission.
Warm white #FDFBF6	Page and card surfaces	Feels friendly and keeps the game readable.

Brand guardrail: this is a charity: water-inspired student concept, not an official charity: water product. The interface uses labeled placeholders for sample stories, photos, locations, and impact metrics until they can be sourced and licensed.

Game logic and visual feedback

Player action	State update	Feedback
Hold spring button	Fill ratio advances from 0–100%.	Meter fills; label changes to "Filling…".
Release before complete	No reward; progress resets.	Meter returns to zero; label returns to "Hold to fill."
Complete a phase	+200 droplets; quest increases up to 5/5.	Button announces "Spring cleared"; HUD updates.
Collect a building	Button becomes disabled for this session.	"Collected" state prevents repeated collection.
Open Stories	View sample content only.	Source/licensing status is visible; donations are disabled.
Claim weekly reward	Local-only state changes.	Button becomes "Reward claimed locally."

Stakeholder reflection

For charity: water stakeholders, the concept should make the clean-water mission understandable without overstating what a game action can accomplish. The strongest opportunity is the bridge between play and learning: each screen can help students understand that infrastructure, time, education, and health are connected. The main stakeholder risks are inaccurate stories, unlicensed images, implied real-world impact, and an unapproved donation experience. My design response is to make provenance visible, keep sample data clearly labeled, and reserve real donation or project attribution for a later approved integration.

Wireframing reflection

Creating the wireframe before a production build helped me decide what the player needs to see at each moment: the action, the progress state, the reward, and the next place to go. The mobile-first layout exposed the importance of thumb-friendly controls and short content blocks. The desktop adaptation helped me separate persistent navigation from the core loop. Building the concept digitally also made it easier to test keyboard access, responsive behavior, and how labels change after an interaction instead of relying only on a static sketch.

AI-assisted ideation note

AI tools were used to brainstorm mechanics, rewards, screen structure, accessibility considerations, and risk controls. I selected and refined the final concept, wrote the player flow, established the visual system, and implemented the digital wireframe. The screenshots and interaction states in this document were verified from the local prototype.

Pilot-readiness checklist

- Complete: four labeled mobile screens and a desktop adaptation.
- Complete: clear player action, progress, reward, and navigation logic.
- Complete: keyboard-accessible hold interaction and visible local-demo boundary.
- Before public release: replace sample stories/photos/locations with approved, licensed sources.
- Before real donations: add an approved payment flow, privacy/consent language, backend validation, and security review.